

Orencia (abatacept) Intravenous



Pharmacy Coverage Policy

Effective Date: January 01, 2026

Revision Date: July 22, 2026

Review Date: July 15, 2026

Line of Business: Medicare

Policy Type: Prior Authorization

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Products Affected

Orencia (with maltose) intravenous solution

Listed Indications

[Rheumatoid Arthritis \(RA\)](#)

[Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis](#)

[Psoriatic Arthritis \(PSA\)](#)

[Prophylaxis of Graft vs. Host Disease](#)

Rheumatoid Arthritis (RA)

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of moderately to severely active rheumatoid arthritis
Criteria #2	The member must be at least 18 years of age or older
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with one of the following: Remicade, Inflectra, Infliximab OR Simponi Aria* *Prior therapy with Simponi Aria applies to medical benefits only. For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days.

Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.

NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.

Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
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Approval Duration

Initial	Plan Year Duration
Renewal	Plan Year Duration

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Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member must have a diagnosis of moderately to severely active polyarticular juvenile idiopathic arthritis.
Criteria #2	The member must be 6 years of age or older.
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with two of the following: • preferred adalimumab product [i.e. Humira (adalimumab), adalimumab-adbm, adalimumab-adaz] • Enbrel • Rinvoq *Prior therapy applies to pharmacy benefits only.

Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.

NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.

Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
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Psoriatic Arthritis (PSA)

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	The member has a diagnosis of active psoriatic arthritis
Criteria #2	The member is at least 18 years of age or older
Criteria #3	The member has had prior therapy, contraindication, or intolerance with: Remicade, Inflectra, Infliximab OR Simponi Aria*; AND Preferred ustekinumab product (i.e., Stelara, Otulfi, Yesintek). For Medicare Part B requests, the step therapy requirements do not apply if the request is continuation of prior therapy within the past 365 days. *Prior therapy with Simponi Aria applies to medical benefits only.

Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.

NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.

Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
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Approval Duration

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Prophylaxis of Graft vs. Host Disease

Does the member meet all of the following criteria?

Criteria #1	Using Orencia for prophylaxis of acute graft versus host disease
Criteria #2	Is undergoing hematopoietic stem cell transplantation from a matched or 1 allele-mismatched unrelated donor
Criteria #3	Is using Orencia in combination with a calcineurin inhibitor (e.g. cyclosporine, tacrolimus) and methotrexate

Does the member have any of the following exclusions? If yes, approval may not be appropriate.

NOTE: Experimental/Investigational Use – Indications not supported by CMS recognized compendia or acceptable peer reviewed literature.

Exclusion #1	Combination therapy with other biologics (e.g. Cosentyx, Enbrel, adalimumab product, Kevzara, Remicade).
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Background

This is a prior authorization policy about Orencia (abatacept).

Warnings and Precautions for Orencia:

- Concomitant use with a TNF antagonist can increase the risk of infections and serious infections.
- Hypersensitivity, anaphylaxis, and anaphylactoid reactions
- Patients with a history of recurrent infections or underlying conditions predisposing to infections may experience more infections

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- Discontinue if a serious infection develops.
- Screen for latent TB infection prior to initiating therapy. Patients testing positive should be treated prior to initiating Orencia.
- Live vaccines should not be given concurrently or within 3 months of discontinuation.
- Screen for viral hepatitis prior to initiating Orencia.
- Update vaccinations prior to initiating Orencia. Based on its mechanism of action, Orencia may blunt the effectiveness of some immunizations.
- COPD patients may develop more frequent respiratory adverse events.
- Cytomegalovirus (CMV) and Epstein-Barr Virus (EBV) reactivation in patients treated for aGVHD prophylaxis.

Orencia (abatacept), a selective co-stimulation modulator, inhibits T cell (T lymphocyte) activation by binding to CD80 and CD86, thereby blocking interaction with CD28. This interaction provides a co-stimulatory signal necessary for full activation of T lymphocytes. Activated T lymphocytes are implicated in the pathogenesis of rheumatoid arthritis (RA) and are found in the synovium of patients with RA.

Orencia (abatacept) IV is indicated for adult patients with moderately to severely active rheumatoid arthritis; pediatric patients 6 years of age and older with moderately to severely active polyarticular juvenile idiopathic arthritis; adult patients with active psoriatic arthritis (PsA); adult and pediatric patients 2 year of age and older for acute graft-versus-host disease (GVHD) prophylaxis in patients undergoing hematopoietic stem-cell transplantation (HSCT) from a matched or 1 allele-mismatched unrelated donor in combination with a calcineurin inhibitor and methotrexate.

Orencia (abatacept) is available as a 250 mg lyophilized powder for intravenous infusion.

Provider Claim Codes

For medically billed requests, please visit www.humana.com/PAL. Select applicable Preauthorization and Notification List(s) for medical and procedural coding information.

Medical Terms

Orencia; abatacept; rheumatoid arthritis; juvenile idiopathic arthritis; psoriatic arthritis; graft versus host disease; intravenous infusion; pharmacy

References

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Disclaimer

State and federal law, as well as contract language, including definitions and specific inclusions/exclusions, take precedence

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over clinical policy and must be considered first in determining eligibility for coverage. Coverage may also differ for our Medicare and/or Medicaid members based on any applicable Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) coverage statements including National Coverage Determinations (NCD), Local Medical Review Policies (LMRP) and/or Local Coverage Determinations. See the CMS website at <http://www.cms.hhs.gov/>. The member's health plan benefits in effect on the date services are rendered must be used. Clinical policy is not intended to pre-empt the judgment of the reviewing medical director or dictate to health care providers how to practice medicine. Health care providers are expected to exercise their medical judgment in rendering appropriate care. Clinical technology is constantly evolving, and we reserve the right to review and update this policy periodically. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any shape or form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying or otherwise without permission from Humana.